

# Cornelia Cifelli

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Senior partnerships and strategy alliances director with expertise in business development building and scaling high-impact collaborations across top-tier brands, nonprofits, education, and government. Proven track record leading complex multi-million-dollar partnership portfolios including Mercedes-Benz, Domino's, Starbucks, the WNBA, MLB, NASCAR, and NCAA. Known for translating strategic priorities into scalable partnership ecosystems that increase visibility, strengthen relationships, and deliver measurable business outcomes.

## Skills

- Strategic Planning & Program Implementation
- Budget Oversight & Resource Management
- Business Develop, Negotiation & Deal Structuring
- CRM Strategy, Reporting & Process Optimization
- Revenue Growth & Go-to-Market Partnerships
- Executive Engagement & Stakeholder Alignment

## Experience

**Partnership Director - Corporate Partnerships and Outreach Strategy**, 05/2023 - 12/2025

*BlueForge Alliance*

- Led execution and strategic coordination of a \$90M partnership and social impact portfolio supporting and advancing business development, and community engagement initiatives.
- Served as the primary subject matter expert for internal and external partners, to ensure all contractual rights and assets are fully leveraged, executed, and optimized to maximize value.
- Negotiated, built, and managed 25+ strategic partnerships across nonprofit, education, corporate, government, and sports organizations including the WNBA, MLB, NASCAR, and NCAA institutions.
- Developed multi-year partnership strategies that increased awareness and engagement by 30% through integrated activations, events, and sponsorship initiatives.
- Directed multi-million-dollar community and philanthropic initiatives, overseeing budgets, stakeholder alignment, vendor management, and implementation strategy.
- Led multi-million-dollar philanthropic initiatives, overseeing budgets, timelines, and cross-functional teams while ensuring successful execution and measurable ROI.

**Global Strategic Lead, Partnerships & Stakeholder Engagement**, 01/2022 - 03/2023

*Jacobs*

- Managed partnership team of 5 direct reports while fostering collaboration with executive leadership to develop global partnership engagement and partnership strategies aligned to long-term organizational growth objectives.
- Built strategic partnerships with universities, industry associations, workforce organizations, and community partners to strengthen organizational visibility and stakeholder engagement globally.
- Developed scalable partnership and outreach frameworks that increased engagement by 20% and identified opportunities that expanded market presence and supported long-term business objectives.
- Managed relationships across internal teams and external partners to strengthen pipelines and organizational relationships across multiple business units, ensuring initiatives remained aligned with enterprise priorities.
- Directed high-impact engagement campaigns reaching more than 1.2M professionals globally across multiple business sectors.

**Senior Strategic Manager, Global Partnerships & Marketing Outreach**, 08/2018 - 06/2021

*Halliburton*

- Built strategic alliances to expand national reach, increase stakeholder engagement, and strengthen awareness initiatives, contributing to a 15% increase in program visibility.
- Developed strategic alliances with universities, workforce organizations, and industry associations to support enterprise growth and long-term organizational objectives.
- Designed strategies that expanded audience reach by more than 100K stakeholders and with cross-functional engagement initiatives designed to strengthen organizational reputation and community alignment.
- Identified, cultivated, and expanded partnership opportunities that increased organizational visibility, stakeholder engagement, and long-term value creation.
- Tracked defined KPIs and analyzed results and identified opportunities to optimize effectiveness and ROI.

## **Associate Director, Client Partnerships & Development, 08/2016 - 08/2018**

### ***NuCery International Inc.***

- Advanced mission-driven partnerships and strategic growth initiatives that identified market opportunities and strengthened long-term revenue potential.
- Lead activation initiatives from planning through execution, including timelines, budgets, deliverables, and agency management to ensure best-in-class work that aligns to strategy and delivers against objectives.
- Led integrated outreach initiatives that significantly increased audience engagement and brand visibility.
- Managed strategic projects across timelines, budgets, and stakeholder groups to ensure effective execution and measurable outcomes.
- Developed messaging and positioning strategies that strengthened organizational credibility and stakeholder connection.

## **Manager, Strategic Partnerships & Client Growth, 01/2015 - 08/2016**

### ***SMMI, Inc***

- Led strategic growth initiatives and partnership campaigns for Fortune 500 brands including Mercedes-Benz, Domino's, and Starbucks. Along with universities, community organizations, and industry associations.
- Managed partnerships and client engagements across 40 brands and multiple national organizations.
- Negotiated partnership agreements and guided cross-functional collaboration to strengthen long-term client relationships and established performance metrics to measure effectiveness and optimize partnership outcomes.
- Delivered data-informed strategic recommendations that improved engagement performance and client retention or upsell by approximately 40% annually.
- Oversaw integrated campaign execution, stakeholder coordination, and performance optimization initiatives.

## **Senior Associate, Partnerships & Brand Development, 03/2012 - 01/2015**

### ***Remax Real Estate Group***

- Led outreach and engagement that increased community visibility and stakeholder engagement by 56%.
- Developed partnership strategies with local organizations and business leaders to expand market reach and strengthen community relationships.
- Used performance analytics and audience insights to improve engagement strategy and campaign effectiveness.
- Coordinated events and activation initiatives supporting organizational growth and brand awareness.

## **Partnership Development Lead, 05/2010 - 01/2015**

### ***KTJ LLC***

- Drove engagement and partnership initiatives designed to increase audience growth and brand visibility 10%.
- Negotiated partnership agreements with vendors and external organizations to support business growth objectives.
- Managed client relationships and insights that helped improve campaign effectiveness and outreach strategy.

## **Strategic Partnerships Coordinator, 02/2010 - 03/2012**

### ***Houston Chronicle***

- Lead partnership-focused outreach and communications initiatives across multiple organizations and campaigns.
- Created content development, stakeholder communications, and audience engagement efforts.
- Increased online digital partnership engagement from 8,000 to more than 15,000 monthly interactions.

## **Partnership Activation & Engagement Specialist, 08/2006 - 01/2010**

### ***Texas State University Bookstore***

- Developed community engagement programs and campus partnership initiatives serving more than 25,000 students annually.
- Coordinated large-scale events that increased participation and strengthened stakeholder relationships.
- Tracked campaign and engagement data to help improve outreach effectiveness and participation.

## **Education**

***Arizona State University - Master's Degree - Strategy and Consumer Behavior***

***Texas State University - Bachelor's Degree - Advertising and Consumer Sciences***

## **Core Competencies**

Partnership Lifecycle, Pipeline Development, Performance Measurement, Partnership Operations, Sponsorship Strategy & Activation, Client Relationship Management, Philanthropic Partnerships, Program Development & Revenue Scaling